



ESADE Ramon Llull University

Business Model Canvas – Business Idea

Team Project 1st Deliverable

Development Tools for Web & Mobile Apps

Pau Gratacos Fuste
Carlos van der Kooij
Lucas Joris Haesaert
Vera Kannewischer
Fabrizio Lacuzio

Supervisors:
Jordi Tardà
José Manuel Alonso

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1. Business Model Canvas: Foundry – Co-founder matching platform

ACTIVITY: What is the purpose of our company/website?

Foundry is a curated co-founder matchmaking platform connecting high-potential founders with complementary skills, values, and ambitions across Europe. Its core purpose is to remove the luck and network bias from one of the most consequential decisions a founder makes: choosing who to build with. The platform collects structured profile data and screening call transcripts, processes them through a hybrid AI and human matching engine, and delivers introductions with a written rationale for every match.

VALUE PROPOSITION: What problems do we solve?

Most founders find co-founders through their immediate network, leading to similarity bias and early team breakdowns. Foundry solves this with a structured matching process that goes beyond skill overlap to assess working style, risk tolerance, and values: the dimensions that predict long-term team survival. Every introduction comes with a "matching thesis" explaining why two people fit, making intros feel intentional rather than algorithmic. Founders also get access to curated events and a peer network, not just a one-time email intro.

COLLABORATION: Who are our partners/suppliers?

Foundry's key partners are startup ecosystems providing access to high-quality founder pipelines: accelerators, university entrepreneurship programs (ESADE, TU Munich, ETH Zurich), and operator communities. Technology partners include LLM providers for transcript processing and archetype scoring. Alumni founders who met their co-founder through Foundry become informal ambassadors and the platform's strongest referral source.

RESOURCES: What do we need to operate?

The hybrid matching engine (rules-based hard filters + LLM soft scoring) is the core technical asset. Human reviewers who conduct screening calls, validate matches, and maintain founder relationships are irreplaceable. The Foundry brand: built around exclusivity, quality, and genuine community is a long-term reputational asset. Operationally, the platform requires LLM API access, email automation, and event logistics capacity across multiple cities.

USERS/CUSTOMERS: Who is this for?

Foundry serves early-stage founders across Europe actively seeking a co-founder, typically at pre-idea, pre-seed, or seed stage. Three core profiles are targeted: technical founders (engineers, product builders) who need a commercial partner; commercial founders (sales, ops, strategy) who need a technical co-builder; and domain experts (healthcare, climate, fintech) who need an execution-focused co-founder. The platform is also implicitly valuable to accelerators and operators who benefit from stronger founding teams entering the market.

CHANNELS: How do we reach founders?

The primary acquisition channel is warm referrals from alumni and partner ecosystems, preserving quality from the first touchpoint. Organic content on LinkedIn and X: founder stories and team-building insights: drives awareness without paid spend. In-person events double as both retention and new member acquisition. University and accelerator partnerships create structured pipeline from programs already filtering for ambitious builders. The Foundry landing page and multi-step application form serve as the main conversion layer, while automated check-in emails reduce dormancy within the existing community.

COSTS: What does it cost to run?

The dominant cost is human time: community managers conducting screening calls, validating matches, coordinating introductions, and managing event logistics across multiple cities. Technology costs include LLM API usage, database and automation tooling, and email infrastructure. Events represent a recurring cost (venue, catering, and coordination) but serve as a high-ROI retention and acquisition mechanism. The two-step LLM pipeline (cheaper model for transcript cleaning, advanced model for archetype scoring) keeps inference costs manageable as the community scales.

REVENUE: What is the business model?

Foundry is free for founders, with the core monetization logic sitting on the operator side: a VC or investment firm running Foundry gains privileged early access to promising founding teams before they ever enter a formal fundraising process. By accompanying founders from the co-founder search stage, the operator builds trust and deal flow at the earliest possible moment.

2. Website concept: What does the product look like online?

Note: The backend matching algorithm and AI processing pipeline are out of scope for this project. The website covers the frontend experience and user-facing flows only.

Page 1: Homepage

- Hero headline: "The co-founder you need isn't in your network yet"
- Single CTA: "Apply to Join" and rotating founder testimonials with name, role, and company
- Live counter: members active, matches made, companies building
- Three-step process preview: Apply > Get Matched > Build

Page 2: How It Works

- Five-stage journey: application, screening call, AI-assisted matching, intro with matching thesis, post-intro support
- FAQ: Is it free? How long does matching take? What if the intro doesn't work out?

Page 3: Apply

- Multi-step form with progress bar
- Section 1: Personal info: name, email, LinkedIn, city, work model
- Section 2: Role & skills: primary skillset, desired co-founder profile, industry
- Section 3: Logistics: full-time or part-time, runway, funding philosophy
- Section 4: Behavioral questions: three situational prompts on working style, conflict, and ambition
- Section 5: Open text: anything the form didn't capture

Page 4: Founder Stories

- Filterable library of matched pairs, browsable by industry, city, and archetype
- Each card: names, roles, what they're building, one-paragraph match story

Page 5: Events

- Calendar of dinners, workshops, and co-working days by city
- RSVP gated to accepted members only
- Past event recaps with photos to signal community culture